



innings had earlier earned him a few more seasons. It could well be the case, especially for a few so-called six-hitters who do hit a six and are then dismissed the next ball. If they keep doing that in most matches, their strike rate will be very impressive, but the overall impact on the game will be negligible.

It is important to carry on and take the team to a good total or take them home if the team is chasing a target, but that rarely happens with the six-hitters of the mohalla leagues.

Even in the IPL format, a batter needs a reasonable technique, as bowlers are capable of delivering a top ball far more often than in the city leagues. While T20 is a game made for sixes, it does not mean sloggers will dominate. If anything, sloggers fail regularly.

Speaking of failure, one can totally understand the sense of frustration that our champion badminton doubles pair felt at the lack of recognition for their achievement in winning the bronze medal in the Thomas Cup. Four years back, they

had won the Thomas Cup, which is like winning the World Cup in other sports. Here, too, the reaction was not as big as it should have been. Perhaps those who do not play badminton do not understand what a tough and demanding sport it is, and so fail to grasp the magnitude of the triumph.

Rather than blaming the general public, it would be a good idea to see if the public was informed adequately by the electronic and print media about the fantastic achievement. How does the general public know where and when the tournaments are unless they learn about them from the media?

While there is the *Indian Express* with terrific sports pages covering all sports, most other print media and websites would rather glorify a cricketer who gets two wickets or hits two sixes in an IPL game. His whole family, uncles and aunties, his village and school teachers, and anybody and everybody are interviewed, and half the sports pages are devoted to that.

Better late than never: The author feels the franchises have learnt their lesson, albeit after a few seasons, and many a one-innings performer found himself ignored at the auction after one standout innings had earlier earned him a few more seasons. K. R. DEEPAK

The die-hard badminton fan will find out from somewhere, but it is the ordinary sports lover who remains in the dark, who will not know the result, and so will be unable to express joy at India winning the badminton equivalent of a World Cup. **Kidambi Srikanth tossing his racquet and holding his face after the point that won India the Thomas Cup is etched in the minds of badminton fans forever.**

Do not worry about the numbers, Satwiksairaj. You perhaps have little idea how much badminton fans adore you and your colleagues for bringing India not only the gold then, but also for giving your all to bring home the bronze just a few weeks ago.